HEXLEY CHEMICALS

Statement Guide: Rescue

Document Guide 04 | Issue 3 | Owner: Permit Office | Review cycle: every twelve months

1. What this guide covers

This guide covers rescue from a confined space: the rescue plan, the standby person at the entry, the rescue equipment, breathing apparatus, raising the alarm and the control room's part. It fills the rescue plan and appears in method statements for confined space entry.

The guide is used by the Permit Coordinator or Area Authority who opens a review - the reviewer in this guide - and by the Area Authority who decides it. Whether a requirement is met is a separate question, settled by the request and its permit type's own standard. This guide is about what the documents show: the tools flag only a gas reading that differs from the request's, as the Permit Rules set out, and every other check here is the reviewer's own.

2. How it shows up in a statement

A sentence of this kind usually says one of these:

- a standby person at the entry who keeps count of who is inside and never enters
- a tripod and winch over the manway, and harnesses with lifelines
- breathing apparatus kept at the entry for rescue
- a rescue plan naming who does what if an entrant collapses
- the alarm raised by radio, and the control room told when entry starts and ends

3. What the reviewer checks

These are the checks the reviewer makes, in this order:

1 Find the request's rescue plan answer for confined space entry.
2 Read each sentence of this kind for the standby person, the equipment and the plan.
3 Check the standby person stays at the entry and never enters.
4 Note a sentence saying there is no rescue plan or no standby person.
5 Check the rescue equipment suits the manway a casualty would come out through.

4. Requirements it bears on

Rescue bears on the rescue plan requirement of the confined space entry standard.

5. When the statement and the request disagree

When a statement says there is no rescue plan or no standby person while the request records a rescue plan in place, the reviewer notes it for the Area Authority and keeps the request's answer.

6. What to ask the requester for

Ask the performing authority for the rescue plan, naming the standby person, the rescue equipment at the entry and how a casualty would be brought out.

7. Telling it apart

Bringing a person out of a space in an emergency is rescue; getting to the work position and working there - a scaffold, a platform, a ladder, a harness clipped to an anchor - is access, which the Access guide covers. "Entrants wear rescue harnesses with lifelines to the surface" is rescue; "harnesses are clipped to an anchor point above the work" is access.